

Reading

The Weekend Woodcarver

Before you read

- Look at the title. What do you think this person does at weekends?
- Do you know anyone who is skilled at a craft hobby?

Ahmet works as an accountant during the week, but every Saturday morning he becomes a completely different person. He puts on an old apron, opens his small garden shed, and picks up a piece of wood and a set of carving tools. Ahmet is passionate about woodcarving, and he has been practising this hobby for almost six years.

It all started when his grandfather gave him a small wooden bird he had carved himself. Ahmet was fascinated and decided he wanted to learn the same skill. At first, he was a complete novice and found the work slow and difficult. He couldn't even carve a simple spoon without cutting his fingers. However, he was fond of the quiet, careful process, and he refused to give up.

Ahmet joined a local craft club, where more experienced members were happy to share tips with beginners. He practised for at least two hours every weekend, and slowly his skills improved. Now he can carve detailed animal figures, small boxes, and even simple furniture. His favourite pieces are wooden birds, just like the one his grandfather gave him.

Ahmet says that woodcarving helps him relax after a stressful week at work. "I enjoy focusing on one small task and seeing something beautiful appear from a plain piece of wood," he explains. He is now keen on entering his work in a regional craft competition next spring, something he could never have imagined doing when he first picked up a carving knife.

1. What is Ahmet's job?
 - a. Woodcarver
 - b. Accountant
 - c. Craft teacher
 - d. Shed builder
2. Ahmet's grandfather gave him a small wooden _____.
3. Ahmet found woodcarving easy from the very beginning. — *True / False*
4. How does Ahmet feel about woodcarving now?
 - a. Bored by it
 - b. Passionate about it
 - c. Confused by it
 - d. Annoyed by it
5. Ahmet is planning to enter a regional craft _____ next spring.

6. What can we infer about Ahmet's attitude towards learning new skills?

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- a. He gives up easily.
 - b. He is patient and determined.
 - c. He prefers to learn alone.
 - d. He only likes fast results.

After you read

- Would you like to try woodcarving? Why or why not?
- What hobby have you learned slowly, like Ahmet learned woodcarving?

Twins, Different Talents

Before you read

- Do you know any twins? Do they usually have the same interests?
- Guess: what different hobbies might two twin sisters have?

Elif and Deniz are twin sisters, but their hobbies could hardly be more different. Elif is crazy about rock climbing. Every weekend, she travels to a climbing centre outside the city, where she can now climb walls that would have seemed impossible to her two years ago. As a child, she couldn't even climb the small tree in their garden without help, so her family is amazed at how far she has come.

Deniz, on the other hand, is interested in something much quieter: chess. She loves sitting for hours studying old games and planning her next move. She joined the school chess club in Year 9 and quickly became one of its strongest players. Unlike her sister, Deniz has always preferred activities that let her think carefully rather than move quickly.

Their parents say that the girls have always had opposite personalities, even though they look almost identical. Elif enjoys taking risks and testing her body's limits, while Deniz prefers solving problems calmly in her mind. Interestingly, both girls agree on one thing: they can't stand giving up on a challenge, whether it's a difficult climbing route or a tricky chess puzzle.

Last month, the twins decided to try something new together: a beginner's pottery class. Neither of them had any experience, and at first their bowls looked more like flat plates. However, after a few lessons, both sisters could shape a simple, even bowl, and they agreed it was fun to be complete beginners together for once.

1. What hobby is Elif crazy about?

- a. Chess
- b. Rock climbing
- c. Pottery
- d. Woodcarving

2. Deniz joined the school _____ club in Year 9.

3. As a child, Elif could easily climb trees. — True / False

4. What do the two sisters have in common, according to the text?

- a. They both prefer quiet activities.
- b. They both can't stand giving up on a challenge.
- c. They both dislike trying new things.
- d. They both started rock climbing together.

5. The twins tried a beginner's _____ class together last month.

6. What can we infer about how the sisters felt during the pottery class?

- a. Embarrassed and unwilling to continue
- b. Amused and encouraged by improving together
- c. Angry that their bowls were not perfect
- d. Uninterested in the activity

After you read

- Do you think it's more common for siblings to share hobbies or have different ones? Why?
- Which of the two sisters' hobbies would you rather try, and why?